

Pembrolizumab versus Ipilimumab in Advanced Melanoma

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BACKGROUND: The immune checkpoint inhibitor pembrolizumab has shown antitumor activity in advanced melanoma...

RESULTS: The estimated 6-month progression-free-survival rates were 47.3% for pembrolizumab every 2 weeks, 46.4% for pembrolizumab every 3 weeks, and 26.5% for ipilimumab. Estimated 12-month survival rates were 74.1%, 68.4%, and 58.2%, respectively.

CONCLUSION: Pembrolizumab prolonged progression-free survival and overall survival and had less high-grade toxicity than did ipilimumab in patients with advanced melanoma.

CLINICAL IMPACT: Proves Keytruda's superiority in treating advanced melanoma patients (e.g. Patient P002, P017) leading to long-term survival.